

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 224

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to commemorate Read Across America Week in Tennessee, March 2-6, 2025.

WHEREAS, reading introduces children to new ideas, cultures, and perspectives, feeding their imaginations and stoking the fires of innovation that help them understand our world as it is and pioneer ways to make it better; we know firsthand how reading can change lives; and

WHEREAS, reading ignites imagination, insight, and inspiration; nourishes creativity and curiosity; and inspires a passion for lifelong learning; books can challenge and inspire, teach important lessons, and reveal new worlds, as well as enrich our understanding of our own—of different people, perspectives, and cultures; and

WHEREAS, on March 2-6, 2025, communities across the United States will come together to participate in Read Across America Week, a celebration organized by the National Education Association that began as a single-day event to honor Dr. Seuss's birthday; this now week-long event is dedicated to promoting literacy, inspiring a love for reading, and highlighting the transformative power of words and stories; and

WHEREAS, during Read Across America Week, we celebrate the joy of learning and give thanks to the parents, caregivers, educators, librarians, authors, and community members who invest in our nation's children; and

WHEREAS, for many young Tennesseans, the path to literacy begins with treasured and timeless traditions: being read to at bedtime, gathering in classrooms for story time, and attending events at local libraries with family and friends; and

WHEREAS, children's classics such as *Green Eggs and Ham* and *Oh, the Places You'll Go!* have inspired a passion for reading and endless creativity that spans generations; as Dr. Seuss once wrote, "The more that you read, the more things you will know. The more that you learn, the more places you'll go"; and

WHEREAS, there is power that is unleashed by reading—discovering the comfort of words in times of sorrow, finding inspiration to fuel our imagination, or having a clear-eyed understanding of our past so we can forge a future of limitless possibilities; and

WHEREAS, today's stories and adventures are as diverse as the world in which we live, and by reading them, we come to more fully understand the vibrant diversity of our State, country, and world; this is especially important as young people learn, grow, and engage with their own sense of identity, as books build each child's sense of belonging and can help inculcate respect and empathy for others; and

WHEREAS, during Read Across America Week, we dedicate ourselves to helping each new generation of readers and thinkers become the leaders who will write a more hopeful chapter in our collective Tennessee story and in the story of our shared world; as the great American writer Toni Morrison reminds us, "If you find a book you really want to read but it hasn't been written yet, then you must write it"; and

WHEREAS, Read Across America Week encourages parents and children to read together, explore their local library, and attend local events hosted by library systems and schools throughout the State; and

WHEREAS, we recognize that there is still more work to do to improve literacy across Tennessee and the country, and we are committed to supporting educators and improving literacy for those of all ages and from all walks of life; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we commemorate March 2-6, 2025, as Read Across America Week, joining states across the country in promoting the value and importance of fostering a lifelong love of reading.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.